Begum Rokeya University, Rangpur • Department of Management Information Systems

INTERNSHIP REPORT

Evaluating MIS Practices in Project Monitoring

A Study on RDRS Bangladesh

Submitted By / Submitted To / Host

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Sources: MEL monitoring schedule • G Banker outputs • C-RANGPUR instrument & F01-112 matrix • KII & field notes • Dishari planner • Somriddhi report • Court audit

Letter of Transmittal

30 November 2026

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Subject: Submission of Internship Report on "Evaluating MIS Practices in Project Monitoring: A Study on RDRS Bangladesh"

Dear Sir,

This is my internship report for BBA in Management Information Systems from Begum Rokeya University, Rangpur. My report discusses my findings of project monitoring and management information system practices from RDRS Bangladesh. This report is written on my three months internship experience in Monitoring, Evaluation and Learning Department (MEL), Central Coordination office of RDRS Rangpur. My internship period was from 01 Sept 2026 to 30 November 2026.

In my three month internship period, I sat with different project and branch staffs and observed the flow of data in field like registered numbers in papers to mobile forms to office dashboards. I went through the C-RANGPUR baseline survey, G Banker Microfinance report, ICPS child protection baseline survey, Access to Justice court count, Jononni field monitoring Lalmonirhat, past monitoring documents. Apart from those tools I created a simple browser based tool, Dishari, to tackle the bottleneck of creation of monthly branch visit schedule by monitoring staff manually in Word and manually calculating annual branch visits.

In my report, I tried to keep myself close to the documents that I read or people with whom I interacted. Thank you for your supervision and patience and comments in the report making process.

Sincerely,
A. R. Mahmud (ID: 12022065)

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Firstly I would like to express my gratitude to my academic supervisor Mohammad Rakibul Islam Bhuiyan. Assistant Professor in the Department of Management Information Systems at Begum Rokeya University, Rangpur. He helped me to understand the areas of importance and also reviewed my drafts. Also I would like to express my gratitude to Mr. Omar Faruque (Associate Professor of the Department of Accounting of Begum Rokeya University), whom I met unexpectedly in Lalmonirhat while doing the field work for Jononni project. It was really great to talk to him about NGO reporting/monitoring checks which are not so much like what we learned in a university classroom.

Secondly I received signed placement schedule for RDRS Bangladesh by Mr. Mamunur Rashid (Head of MEL), Dabasish Mahata (Coordinator-Monitoring). They accepted me to the Rangpur office. Also they guided me on weekly basis. I learned baseline structure, indicators and environmental safeguards for almost 2 hours from Md. Saiful Alam (Shekul) at the ICPS baseline team. I got to know about running projects, day to day MEL work and map of organizations presence in Bangladesh from Fahmida Mostafa (Senior MEL Officer). I received insights on 30 years' micro-finance software's journey at RDRS by Mr. Iftekharul Islam (Manager-Monitoring) and even the work of my grandfather which was involved in early Micro Bank system. I got to know about C-RANGPUR KoBo survey. Vulnerability index calculation. File to Power BI pathway from Md. Ajazul Haque (Manager, MEL).

Special thanks also go to Moushumi Akter, Maydul Islam, Md. Ziaur Rahman, Dr. Salah Uddin, Pallab Goswami, Rashedul Arefeen, Rumana Azim Ansari, Maj Shammita Kabir (Retd) for their valuable time during field rotation or department brief. Also special thanks to the head of Jononni project and paralegals of Access to Justice in Rangpur for permitting me to sit and observe their activities. I also got a lot of encouragement from my family members and friends of my class throughout the term. The errors in this report, if any, are my own.

Executive Summary

Guiding question How is the monitoring data at the village level or at the branch desk communicated to the management level of RDRS Bangladesh? Where does the system fail or work?

I worked in the MEL department of RDRS Central Coordination office Rangpur for 3 months from 01 September 2026 to 30 November 2026. I did not take the brochures as it is. Instead of that, I observed what type of records they open on their desks. For regular branch visits, which they do based on printed registers and regular excel sheets. For ad-hoc projects they use KoBo Toolbox apps in android phones for survey. For Rangpur office, they format exports in excel, make some charts using power BI, get micro finance info using G Banker. I had a defined schedule based on an official schedule approved by Head of MEL. You can find that full schedule at the end of this report. I went to do baseline field work, branch audit, Lalmonirhat for jononni project, short term HR work, agriculture, social development, safeguarding, administration etc.

Two different stories came out of those weeks.

Reporting in microfinance is regular and automated. There was in-house software called Micro Bank. Which they used in their microfinance from 1995 to 2011. There were few (1 or 2 at max) senior people who knows most of the queries. It is risky for the NGO when they grow up. When they shifted to South Tech in 2011, then around 2017/18 they shifted to G Banker. Now 1 click generation of balance sheet (POMIS-5), Income statement (POMIS-4), credit organizer change sheet (288 branches). When the rules for indicators (like portfolio at risk, on time repayment) are implemented on a shared software system, the NGO doesn't face any delays when one of the programmers is not available.

The monitoring of a development project is much more scattered. C-RANGPUR baseline is collected on 10 sections KoBo form by field staff to feed into 7 indicators and a Household Climate Vulnerability Index (Exposure 30% + Sensitivity 30% + Adaptive Capacity Deficit

40%). Even when KoBo is clean on phone collection, field staff export Excel and run macros before uploading on Power BI. Project side has no relation with G Banker at all.

The friction is observed at the moment the paper meets the screen. From the May 2023 monitoring report of Somriddhi programme I found some numerical facts like: in Beruabari union, central MIS showed 100% student attendance but classroom rollbooks showed 89% attendance. On the field visit 65% expenditure file were found absent in rehabilitation grant of BDT 100,000. There was high teacher turnover rate. Guardian Life insurance (Credit Shield) claims are still bundles of papers to go through 4 office levels before getting claim settlement.

Within the MEL office I observed an everyday friction. Monthly microfinance branch monitoring schedule (for branches) was manually prepared by the coordinator in a Microsoft Word table, considering working days considering Friday/Saturday weekends and public holidays, by manually typing branch names in 332 branches, coverage in monthly separate files. I developed a browser app in October/November Dishari to automate this Word process and to generate multi-month coverage reports.

Three practical fixes 1. Do not lock monthly branch reports till monitoring officer will do spot check of physical field registers and will match with digital numbers and confirm with signature 2. Make KoBo linked with Power BI directly so that nobody will calculate vulnerability manually through excel again 3. Use browser scheduler like Dishari or similar which will review rules to make monthly officer roster and annual branch coverage without need of manual Word table

Contents

Letter of Transmittal **i**

Acknowledgement **iii**

Executive Summary **iv**

1 Introduction **1**

1.1 Background of the Study 1

1.2 Objectives of the Study 1

1.3 Scope of the Study 2

1.4 Methodology 2

1.4.1 How the three months ran 2

1.4.2 People I interviewed and met 3

1.4.3 Documents and software I reviewed 3

1.5 Limitations of the Study 4

2 Organizational Overview **5**

2.1 About RDRS Bangladesh 5

2.2 Mission, Vision, and Core Values 6

2.3 Field Scale and Geographic Coverage 6

2.4 Governance and Departmental Organization 6

2.5 The MEL Department 7

2.6 The Five Core Program Domains 8
2.7 Microfinance Products: Udayan, Unnoti, and Savings Schemes 9

3 Literature Review **10**
3.1 Management Information Systems in Practice 10
3.2 Project Monitoring Frameworks 10
3.3 MIS Lessons from NGO and Microfinance Environments 11

4 Analysis and Findings **12**
4.1 MIS Tools and Systems Used in Project Monitoring 12
4.1.1 The observed tool stack 12
4.1.2 Baseline design lifecycle: lessons from ICPS 13
4.1.3 C-RANGPUR baseline survey instrument 13
4.1.4 Indicator formulas and mathematical definitions 15
4.1.5 Household Climate Vulnerability Index (HCVI) 17
4.1.6 The MEL matrix and the C-RANGPUR digital pipeline 19
4.1.7 Microfinance software evolution: Micro Bank to South Tech to G Banker 19
4.2 Data Flow: From Grassroots Field Units to Management Dashboards . . . 21
4.3 Field Visit to Lalmonirhat: Watching the Jononni Project 22
4.4 Special Monitoring Protocols: Where MIS Meets Physical Verification . . . 23
4.5 Risk Control Linked to MIS: Credit Shield Microinsurance 23
4.6 Regulatory Recordkeeping: AML/CFT 24
4.7 Credit Governance and Approval Authority 24
4.8 Case Study: Access to Justice for Women (A2J) 24
4.9 Building Dishari: Fixing the Manual Schedule and Reporting Problem . . . 27

4.9.1 Problems in the manual Word schedule and reporting flow 27
4.9.2 How I designed and built Dishari 28
4.10 Observed Strengths of Current MIS Practices 32
4.11 Observed Gaps and Field-Level Data Discrepancies 33
4.12 Summary Findings Matrix 34
4.13 Placement Activity Log 34

5 Recommendations 38

5.1 Require a Physical Register Sign-Off Before Monthly Lock 38
5.2 Automate the KoBo-to-Power BI Link for Development Projects 38
5.3 Adopt Rule-Checked Scheduling with Dishari and Digitize Paper Dossiers . 39

6 Conclusion 40

A Appendices 43

A.1 Semi-Structured Field Interview Guide 43
A.2 Glossary of Local and Court Terms 43
A.3 C-RANGPUR Verification Notes 44
A.4 Access to Justice (A2J) Field Notes 44
Schedule for the Internship Program at RDRS Bangladesh 45

List of Figures

2.1 Fifty years of RDRS Bangladesh across three major milestones. 5

4.1 The six-step baseline design process (ICPS project, September 2026). . . . 13

4.2 The C-RANGPUR data flow from phone capture to Power BI. 19

4.3 Three generations of microfinance MIS software at RDRS: 1995 to 2026. . . 20

4.4 Dual-track monitoring flow coordinated by the MEL Department. 21

4.5 Rangpur District court caseload from the April 2025 manual audit. 26

4.6 Dishari Step 1 (Plan): Sunday-first October 2026 calendar, draggable visit windows, and officer roster. 28

4.7 Dishari Step 2 (Assign): 22 officer-window slots, searchable 332-branch catalog, and Unassigned Branches rail. 29

4.8 Dishari Step 3 (Review): 0 to 100 readiness checker, ignored exception tray, and live A4 Landscape Print Preview. 30

4.9 Dishari Reports view (shown on the illustrative 12-month 2026 demo dataset): KPI cards, SVG coverage donut, top branches, and Northern Bangladesh district tile map. 31

4.10 Field register versus central MIS gaps recorded in the Somriddhi audit. . . 33

List of Tables

1.1 Staff Interviews and Field Conversations 3

2.1 Institutional Footprint and Microfinance Scale 7

2.2 Active Projects Observed During Placement 8

4.1 Tools Used Daily in the MEL Department 12

4.2 Structure of the C-RANGPUR Baseline Survey Instrument 14

4.3 Mathematical Definitions of C-RANGPUR Project Indicators 16

4.4 HCVI Score Interpretation Bands 18

4.5 MEL Matrix Planning Row for Indicator 1.1 19

4.6 Key Informant Interview with Md. Ajazul Haque, Manager (MEL) 20

4.7 Criminal Caseload Breakdown in Rangpur Courts (April 2025) 26

4.8 Manual Word Schedule Workflow Compared to Dishari 32

4.10 Internship Fieldwork and Office Activity Log 34

4.9 Consolidated MIS Findings at RDRS Bangladesh 37

Abbreviations MEL – Monitoring, Evaluation and Learning; MEAL – Monitoring, Evaluation, Accountability and Learning; ESS – Environmental and Social Safeguard; TOR – Terms of Reference; FGD – Focus Group Discussion; KII – Key Informant Interview; HH – Household; IGA – Income Generating Activity; CSA – Climate Smart Agriculture; HCVI – Household Climate Vulnerability Index (EI – Exposure Index; SI – Sensitivity Index; ACI – Adaptive Capacity Index); NCD – Non-Communicable Disease; SPSS – Statistical Package for the Social Sciences; PKSF – Palli Karma-Sahayak Foundation; CO – Credit Organizer; OTR – On-Time Repayment; PAR – Portfolio at Risk; DQA – Data Quality Assessment; ELCO – Eligible Couple; PW – Pregnant Woman; ATM – Assistant Thana Manager (historic); MSDS – Monthly Savings Deposit Scheme; WASH – Water, Sanitation and Hygiene; LRL – Livelihood Restoration Loan; BFIU – Bangladesh Financial Intelligence Unit; A2J – Access to Justice for Women; GIZ – Deutsche Gesellschaft für Internationale Zusammenarbeit; ADR – Alternative Dispute Resolution; DLAO – District Legal Aid Officer / Office; DLAC / UZLAC / UPLAC – District / Upazila / Union Parishad Legal Aid Committee; LSID – Legal Service Information Desk; PNGO – Partner Non-Governmental Organization; CDR – Community Dispute Resolution; GRO – General Register Officer (Court Police); ATT / CT / AHTT / ST – Anti-Terrorism / Cyber / Anti-Human Trafficking / Special Tribunal; CrPC – Code of Criminal Procedure; DBLA – District Bar Legal Aid.

CHAPTER 1

Introduction

1.1 Background of the Study

My understanding in the BBA classes of Begum Rokeya University that MIS books always provide the diagrams where transactions are directly feeding in the executive dashboard. However, the scenario of NGO in northern Bangladesh is completely different. It has to maintain MIS operation in the midst of poor mobile coverage in the river islands, hand-written passbooks, donor's strict timelines, and staff rotation in more than hundreds of distant offices.

My study in Monitoring, Evaluation and Learning (MEL) Department of RDRS Bangladesh was to understand the flow of monitoring data in a big NGO. RDRS Bangladesh has presence in 33 districts where more than 1.6 million people are served. There are a number of paper-registers, mobile apps, excel sheets and central databases that maintain data related to loans, health clinics, climate survey, legal support etc. I wanted to know: Who records the data? What tools they use? How do they manage mistakes? Where in the process I can use software to help mitigate the common bottleneck?

1.2 Objectives of the Study

My overall objective was to study the MIS tools and practices used by RDRS Bangladesh in monitoring their projects and microfinance branches. My specific objective was to identify the manual and digital tools that MEL Department is using. To identify the data flow from village groups to management in Rangpur and Dhaka. To detect where and how mistake or latency is introduced in the process. To develop a software prototype for the manual

monthly schedule issue that I observed in the office. To provide practical recommendations based on site realities.

1.3 Scope of the Study

This report contains information about my observation through my 3-month internship from 01 September to 30 November 2026 at RDRS Central Coordination Office Rangpur and also through field visit. I worked on files and people under C-RANGPUR, ICPS CP baseline, Jononni MH Lalmonirhat, SEEDS, A2J, Udayan, Unnoti Microfinance Portfolio, May 2023 Somriddhi monitoring archive report, Microfinance monthly monitoring schedule. No external audit of financial statement, statutory governance board and beyond MEL office regular monitor programme.

1.4 Methodology

1.4.1 How the three months ran

Mr. Mamunur Rashid, the Head of MEL has formulated 13-step internship plan for me (copied in the last section of this report (Section A.4)). September first 10 days were spent in Rangpur Central Coordination office learning about RDRS history, 5 program areas and MEL reports' structure. From 13th to 17th September, I was accompanied by Moushumi Akter for field observation of C-RANGPUR project baseline data collection on KoBo. From 20th to 24th September, I followed Maydul Islam and Md. Ziaur Rahman in branch visits within Rangpur region to observe passbook crosschecking, matching loan in manual to digital.

In the late September, I have had a quick one-day rotation with HR unit (Md. Ziaur Rahman) Agriculture, Rupantar project (Dr. Salah Uddin, Pallab Goswami), Social Development, Union Federation (Rashedul Arefeen), Safeguarding (Rumana Azim Ansari) and Admin, General Services (Maj Shammita Kabir-retd). For the period 04th October - 12th November, I have spent majority of the time inside the MEL office (Dabasish Mahata, Md. Ajazul Haque) - learning the rules of KoBo survey, math behind the Vulnerability Index, G Banker exports, counting number of court dockets, etc. In the same timeframe,

I have visited Lalmonirhat for a Jononni project field visit and created Dishari scheduling app for the monthly roster of officers in the department. In the last two weeks of November, I have focused on collating this report and presenting my finding to the MEL team.

1.4.2 People I interviewed and met

I have found most of the primary source material from in-depth face-to-face sessions, system walkthroughs and random field exchanges with the individuals who actually run the processes. Refer Table 1.1 for the details.

Table 1.1. Staff Interviews and Field Conversations

Person	Role	What we covered
Md. Saiful Alam (Shekul)	ICPS Baseline Team (ex-MEAL & GIS, Save the Children)	Two-hour talk on MEL work, the 6-step baseline flow, 21 UNICEF indicators, and ESS rules.
Fahmida Mostafa	Senior MEL Officer	Active projects, daily reporting chain, five program areas, and RDRS coverage counts.
Mr. Iftekharul Islam	Manager, Monitoring	Thirty years of microfinance software, from ATM ledgers and Micro Bank to South Tech and G Banker.
Md. Ajazul Haque	Manager (MEL)	C-RANGPUR survey design on KoBo, HCVI 30/30/40 weights, Excel cleanup, and Power BI charts.
Jononni Project Head & Assoc. Prof. Omar Faruque	Jononni Head (RDRS); Assoc. Prof., Accounting, BRUR	Field visit in Lalmonirhat looking at maternal/neonatal tracking, ELCO/PW registers, and field verification.
A2J Project Focal & Paralegals	Access to Justice for Women	Rangpur court docket count across *Ejlash* and *Serestha*, LSID desk intake, and mediation referrals.

1.4.3 Documents and software I reviewed

In addition to interviews, I have found the department internal materials helpful: Monthly Monitoring Plan (September 2026), live G Banker exports from Udayan office (Program Changes (CO wise), POMIS-4, POMIS-5), C-RANGPUR Enketo form (`https:`

//ee-eu.kobotoolbox.org/x/wzjSgzZ6), Word specification of the form, Monitoring matrix spreadsheet (F01-112), RDRS 6th Strategic Plan (2023-2027), Annual Report (2021-22), Guardian Life Credit Shield policy notes (July 2024), AML/CFT manual (Jan 2022), Somriddhi field monitoring report (Panchagarh/Kurigram -May 2023).

1.5 Limitations of the Study

What I was able to check was actually limited by a few real life issues. 1. 3 months is not a very long period. Not all projects could be tracked from the beginning to the end. 2. G Banker and KoBo IT admins don't allow access to SQL servers directly. So it was not possible to inspect data in database tables. But instead, I have used exported spreadsheets, front-end forms, user manuals. 3. C-RANGPUR and ICPS were both at the initial baseline phase during the time I was there. So, no endline to compare. For any number or policy limit I have mentioned in the report, I mentioned the exact documents/conversation where it was taken.

CHAPTER 2

Organizational Overview

2.1 About RDRS Bangladesh

RDRS was formed post Liberation war. In February 1972, Lutheran World Federation (Department for World Service- Geneva) established a relief program in Rangpur, aimed at providing food, shelter materials, medical clinics, seeds and farm tools to the war-affected villages of NW Bangladesh. Initially, it was called Rangpur Dinajpur Relief Service. As relief operations were transformed into farming and educational programs, it was renamed Rangpur Dinajpur Rural Service. In 1997, it was registered as an independent Bangladeshi NGO under the Trust Act. The Trust has its own national Board of Trustees.

The choice to focus the geography on the northwest is intentional. The region has had decades of experience with periodic flooding of Teesta, Jamuna, Brahmaputra and other rivers, riverbank erosion, disconnection to Dhaka, the hunger season before harvest (called Monga locally). RDRS has evolved through over 50 years from providing relief (1972-1975) to schools and health posts (1976-1989) to local registration and community federations (1990-1997) to a wide-ranging microfinance and climate work. RDRS celebrated its 50th year in February 2022 and is in its 6th Strategic Plan (2023-2027) at the moment. The Executive offices are based in House 43, Road 10, Sector 6, Uttara of Dhaka. Field operations are managed from the Central Coordination Office on Jail Road, Rangpur.



Figure 2.1. Fifty years of RDRS Bangladesh across three major milestones.

2.2 Mission, Vision, and Core Values

From the 2023-2027 Strategic Plan, RDRS envisions a peaceful and just society where people can live dignified lives without any poverty, pain or ignorance in a sustainable environment. The mission of RDRS is to work with marginalized communities and their organizations to make households resilient and able to enhance their lives without continuous need of NGO help.

The company's official values are Compassion, Commitment, Innovation, Adaptability, Accountability. But as day to day discussions go, people in the field speak about them very simply. It's about treating women fairly, getting the loan passbook clean. About responding promptly to complaints. And for an MIS intern, it's about being accountable. Does the ledger say the same thing as the dashboard does for the month?

2.3 Field Scale and Geographic Coverage

Fahmida Mostafa showed me the current organizational structure at the orientation and I double-checked on the microfinance numbers against the December 2024 Portfolio Sheet (Table 2.1).

2.4 Governance and Departmental Organization

There is an independent Board of Trustees and General Body and day-to-day management is done by an Executive Director. For any foreign-funded project we must get approval from NGO Affairs Bureau for Foreign Donations Regulation Act 2016 (FD-6 etc.) plus annual external audit. Microfinance lending is licensed by Microcredit Regulatory Authority (MRA).

Field management runs through 3-layers of management: 16-17 regional offices > 59-61 area offices > 278-288 (depending on size of sub-units that are counted in a given year) branch offices. Then on village level we have 406 autonomous Union Federations for local mediation/government safety net allowances demand/participation in local committees etc.

Table 2.1. Institutional Footprint and Microfinance Scale

Dimension	Scale / Count	Where and what it covers
Union Federations	406 Federations	Member-run apex bodies sitting at Union level
Administrative Reach	33 Districts, 183 Upazilas	872 Unions across Bangladesh
Program Participants	1,642,724 Individuals	Roughly 1.64 million people reached directly
Main Working Belt	Rangpur Division	Kurigram, Gaibandha, Thakurgaon, Dinajpur, Nilphamari, Panchagarh, Rangpur, Lalmonirhat
Other Field Areas	Humanitarian & Regional	Ukhiya and Teknaf in Cox's Bazar; smaller offices in Sylhet, Mymensingh, and Rajshahi
Microfinance Branches	288 Branch Offices	29 districts; 21,134 samity groups; 458,819 members; 377,250 borrowers
Portfolio Numbers	Financial Totals	BDT 5.14B member savings; BDT 15.09B outstanding loans; 95.08% recovery rate

2.5 The MEL Department

This team of staff is stationed in Rangpur and reports to the Head of MEL. They are like an internal data auditing unit for RDRS. Monitoring officers are stationed outside of the project implementation teams to provide unbiased audits.

Branch managers, credit organizers, and project field officers share data with MEL on a monthly basis. MEL staff compare physical passbooks and register records to electronic summaries. They conduct random checks in the field. They consolidate spreadsheets by division. They create monthly reports for higher-level management. If a branch mistypes a sum, or a enumerator misses half of their survey, they should identify the issue before sending the data to Dhaka.

2.6 The Five Core Program Domains

There are five thematic areas for RDRS' activities. The monitoring officers provide support for all of them, instead of being exclusively tied to one grant. Skills, Employment, and Entrepreneurship includes vocational training, youth programs, and market linkages. Social Empowerment includes Union Federations, legal aid services, work against child marriage, and gender justice. Agriculture, Food Security, and Climate Change includes flood-resistant crops, solar irrigation, and adaptation. Microfinance and Employment Creation includes collateral-free group loans, individual business loans, savings, and microinsurance. Emergency and Humanitarian Response includes flood response in northern chars. Also, support for refugees in Cox's Bazar. Table 2.2 shows the common projects that I encountered in my 3-month period.

Table 2.2. Active Projects Observed During Placement

Project	What it does	Donor, dates, and scale
Jononni	Maternal and neonatal health; ELCO/PW tracking and safe delivery	Save the Children; March 2023–December 2027; active in Rangpur and Lalmonirhat (see Section 4.3)
SEEDS	Schooling and livelihoods for adibashi adolescent girls	Strømme Foundation; January 2024–December 2028; 3,000 families
MCGL	Maternal, newborn, and child health system support	U.S. Department of State via Jhpiego; active in Panchagarh and Rangpur
ICPS	Disability-inclusive child protection systems	UNICEF; June 2026–December 2027; Budget: BDT 2,20,40,834 (Section 4.1.2)
C-RANGPUR	Climate resilience, CSA adoption, and household vulnerability	RDRS MEL Department; baseline launched September 2026 (Section 4.1.3)
A2J for Women	Formal court legal aid, court-annexed mediation, and docket audits	Law & Justice Division (MoLJPA) & German GIZ; 1 Mar 2024–31 Dec 2026 (extended to Mar 2027); BDT 1.82 crore (Section 4.8)

2.7 Microfinance Products: Udayan, Unnoti, and Savings Schemes

Adding more about product. Because MIS overview would sound quite flat if every loan is the same. RDRS breaks down microcredit into borrowers depending on their stage in microcredit and purpose.

Udayan is group based loan to recently joined village women. Group members meet in samity every week. They cross guarantee their loan installments. They make compulsory savings every week. When borrower has a good repayment history and wants more capital, she can go for Unnoti which is individually underwritten on household business cash flow, not group based liability.

Compulsory savings is common for both of them. Every member must make at least BDT 50 every week (minimum of BDT 200 per month for Udayan borrowers and BDT 500 for Unnoti clients) for a 6% annual profit share. General Voluntary savings may be opened with up to BDT 10000. This comes with 7% simple interest. Monthly savings deposit scheme (MSDS) may be opened to fix the amount for 3 years 7% and 5 years 7.5% interest rate.

Got 2 targeted loan schemes mentioned in policy papers I have read. Water Credit - for deep tube well and sanitary latrine. (BDT 10,000 to 100,000). Running in 93 branches - Dinajpur, Nilphamari, Thakurgaon, Panchagarh, Habiganj, Moulvibazar. Not only cash, but also hygiene training and technical installation check. Livelihood Restoration Loan (LRL Phase 2) - a loan scheme for post Covid-19 recovery. Max up to BDT 50,000. 6 months grace period. Max 24 months. 8% declining-balance service charge, repaid in 18 monthly installments.

Why loan type changes monitoring For a Udayan loan, you go and verify the weekly samity collection sheet and member's passbooks. For Unnoti loans, you go and verify the cashflow of the business and who all signed at the Area/Regional level. For water credit, you go and see if there is an actual physical latrine or tube well built. The details of how all of these are validated on the ground by the monitoring officers are presented in Chapter 4.

CHAPTER 3

Literature Review

3.1 Management Information Systems in Practice

Laudon and Laudon (2020) describe MIS as an assembly of people, work processes, hardware and software that records, processes and disseminates information that will enable decision making by managers [8]. For most courses in business schools the MIS will be discussed in terms of corporate ERP software, cloud servers, instant database updates etc.

In the NGO/microfinance world, rarely is it the cost of a fancy software that is a real hurdle. It is the confidence in the number at the bottom of a monthly table. How pristine is the central dashboard when it is constructed from the handwritten village Credit Organizer's data collection sheet or the field enumerator's data entry on a phone. In this world, what you need in terms of MIS are clear rules for verification and regular field visits to spot errors at a very early stage.

3.2 Project Monitoring Frameworks

The OECD-DAC framework describes monitoring as the continuous monitoring of project activities and related indicators during the implementation phase [9]. This is different from the periodic evaluation which assesses the long-term impact of the intervention. Through the monitoring process, managers get early alerts if the budget is straying, activities are not progressing, or the targets are not being met.

The 3 habits needed for a functional monitoring system that were highlighted in RDRS: Baseline studies: document the status of households before the start of any project activity to create a genuine point of comparison for future changes. Data Quality Assessments (DQA): verify the validity, reliability, accuracy and timeliness of data reported. Mixed

methods: combine these two habits by using household numbers + Focus Group Discussions (FGD) + Key Informant Interviews (KII) to explain the reasons behind data changes.

3.3 MIS Lessons from NGO and Microfinance Environments

Microfinance and NGO monitoring team studies consistently show that there are three main issues (common to what I saw in Rangpur)

1) first, there were a lot of early NGO computerisations with custom software and usually only one or two smart staff programmers. It's fine if volumes are low, but when that staff member moves or retires it gets risky. Documented, multi-user software such as G Banker helps keep the institutional memory intact.

Secondly, errors are introduced in the last mile between the physical paper and digitised numbers. If field teams are incentivised to achieve 100% then there is a tendency for them to report self reported numbers which differ from the classroom rolls (or passbooks) if there is no independent monitoring officer to physically verify the paper trails.

Thirdly, scheduled monthly visits are better than ad hoc requests from head office. Better record keeping is achieved if you have a fixed monthly calendar in place that tells you which officer visits which branch on which days, instead of asking branches for ad hoc files at the end of the quarter.

CHAPTER 4

Analysis and Findings

This chapter will discuss what I saw during my 3 months in Rangpur and in the field during my time in the districts. This includes what's in my daily log, interviews, system walkthroughs and internal monitoring documents.

4.1 MIS Tools and Systems Used in Project Monitoring

4.1.1 The observed tool stack

Within the MEL department, tasks are divided into four main tools used for routine (monthly) and ad-hoc (project survey) activities (see Table 4.1).

Table 4.1. Tools Used Daily in the MEL Department

Job	Tool Used	Why staff use it
Routine branch work	Structured Excel sheets and paper registers	Standard templates; paper registers leave a physical audit trail at branch level
Ad-hoc and baseline surveys	KoBo Toolbox (mobile app and Enketo)	Offline mobile forms in flood-prone chars; skip logic built in; quick export to Excel
Central data cleanup	Microsoft Excel	Pivot tables, manual cleaning, and formula joins across branches
Visual summaries	Microsoft Power BI	KPI charts and donor-ready dashboards
Microfinance books	G Banker	Web-based MFI ledger across 288 branches; one-click POMIS reports and PAR math

For routine branch monitoring, officers rely on typical excel templates and paper registers. If there is a new baseline study, they create the form using KoBo Toolbox software (on

European servers). Data collectors use KoBo collect (or Enketo Express) through Android phones (offline) in remote chars to collect information and then upload the information when they have mobile access.

4.1.2 Baseline design lifecycle: lessons from ICPS

I spent two hours with Md. Saiful Alam (Shekul) to understand how project baseline is created from scratch (in this case ICPS project: Strengthening Disability-Inclusive Child Protection Systems to Prevent and Respond to Violence against Children with Disabilities in Selected Communities in Bangladesh). UNICEF is the donor of this project with budget of BDT 2,20,40,834. Output 4.2 (social service systems) and Output 4.3 (harmful practices). The baseline survey fieldwork is live in September 2026.

Saiful explained six stages to any baseline before enumerators start working in the village. (Figure 4.1) A review of the project document, selection of indicators, completion of indicator matrix, baseline concept paper, formal Terms of Reference (TOR), and Inception report (with finalized sampling and tools). UNICEF provided 21 ICPS indicators. Soft indicators (like community attitudes) are assessed through FGDs and KIIs. Hard indicators (numbers of violence or service use) by Household survey. He explained Environmental and Social Safeguards (ESS) and what staff call MEL maturity (or how normal/credible NGOs have become in monitoring).

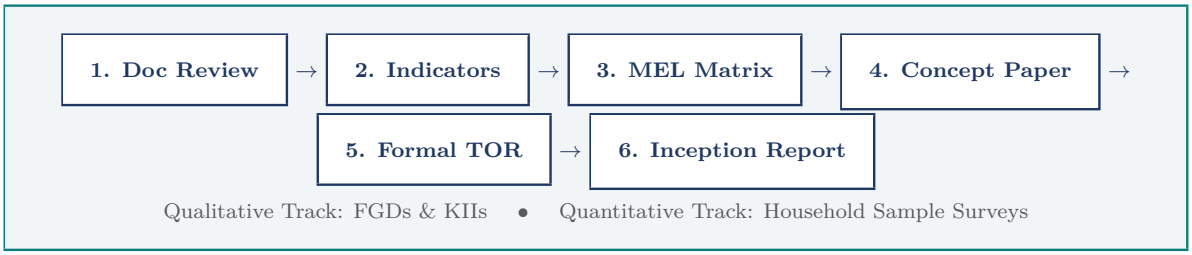


Figure 4.1. The six-step baseline design process (ICPS project, September 2026).

4.1.3 C-RANGPUR baseline survey instrument

I looked at digital survey logic in detail. I reviewed the C-RANGPUR baseline survey questionnaire file *Baseline_Questionnaires_of_CRANGPUR_-*

_Indicator_Result_Measerment.docx (I copied the spelling). I also viewed the live Enketo Express survey at https://ee-eu.kobotoolbox.org/x/wzjSgzZ6

There are ten survey sections. Table 4.2 Section 1-4 includes where the household is located. Respondent. Family composition. Assets. Project indicators 1.1 to 3.2 are in sections 5 to 9. And Section 10 is the 16 item Household Climate Vulnerability Index (HCVI).

Table 4.2: Structure of the C-RANGPUR Baseline Survey Instrument

#	Section Title	Variables Captured	Target Indicator
1	Location Background	District, Upazila, Union, Ward, Village; Hazard zones: Char, Riverbank erosion, Flood, Waterlogging, Drought	Geographic controls
2	Respondent Profile	Name, sex, NID, phone, ethnicity, marital status, education, occupation, disability type, prior RDRS membership	Beneficiary ID
3	Household Composition	Household head details; counts of children under 5, pregnant/lactating women, elderly (60+), disabled	Vulnerability profile
4	Assets & Infrastructure	Housing material, electricity, drinking water, latrines, 14 livestock/asset types, land tenure	Baseline asset base
5	Livelihoods & Income	Income sources (15 codes), IGA support, CSA awareness/adoption (18 practices), 3-year income trend	Indicators 1.1, 1.2
6	Community Participation	Membership in 21 community bodies, attendance, speaking up, female leadership	Indicator 2.1

#	Section Title	Variables Captured	Target Indicator
7	Social Services & Claims	Safety-net receipt (14 types), claims filed, response received, resolution status	Indicator 2.2
8	Primary Health Access	Health care seeking across 13 facilities (incl. RDRS Eye Care), barriers to treatment	Indicator 3.1
9	Non-Communicable Diseases	8 diagnosed NCD conditions (hypertension, diabetes, cataract, etc.), screening history, lifestyle	Indicator 3.2
10	Climate Vulnerability	16-item scored module: Exposure (5), Sensitivity (5), Adaptive Capacity (6)	HCVI composite

4.1.4 Indicator formulas and mathematical definitions

In excel sheet F01-112, all C-RANGPUR indicators have the explicit numerator and denominator to avoid situation where two officers use different way to compute the same rate.

Standard Indicator Calculation Logic

$$\text{Indicator Result (\%)} = \left(\frac{\text{Observed Target Numerator (Eligible Population Meeting Criteria)}}{\text{Total Baseline Denominator (Surveyed Sample Group)}}\right) \times 100$$

Percentage formula used across all C-RANGPUR indicators in matrix F01-112.

Table 4.3 lists all seven operational formulas from the matrix.

Table 4.3: Mathematical Definitions of C-RANGPUR Project Indicators

Indicator	Operational Definition	Numerator / Denominator	Formula
1.1	Climate-affected households adopting ≥1 additional IGA (+25% from baseline)	Num: Households adopting ≥1 new IGA Den: Total targeted households surveyed	$\frac{\text{Num}}{\text{Den}} \times 100$
1.2	≥40% of farming households increasing income by 20% via Climate Smart Agriculture	Num: Households adopting ≥1 promoted CSA practice Den: Total targeted farming households surveyed	$\frac{\text{Num}}{\text{Den}} \times 100$
2.1	Active participation of disadvantaged people in local decision-making (+30% from baseline)	Num: Disadvantaged members attending meetings, speaking, AND having opinions considered Den: Total disadvantaged respondents surveyed	$\frac{\text{Num}}{\text{Den}} \times 100$
2.1 (women)	Female active participation in community decision-making bodies	Num: Female respondents meeting all 2.1 criteria Den: Total female respondents surveyed	$\frac{\text{Num}}{\text{Den}} \times 100$
2.2	Proportion of citizen claims resolved by local public authorities	Num: Claims fully or partially resolved by authorities Den: Total formal claims submitted in period	$\frac{\text{Num}}{\text{Den}} \times 100$

Indicator	Operational Definition	Numerator / Denominator	Formula
3.1	25% of disadvantaged members accessing formal primary health care	Num: Respondents receiving care at public/RDRS clinic Den: Respondents reporting health need in last 12 months	$\frac{\text{Num}}{\text{Den}} \times 100$
3.2	Reduction in selected NCD prevalence by 25% against baseline	Num: Adults diagnosed with $\geq$1 selected NCD Den: Total adult respondents surveyed	$\frac{\text{Num}}{\text{Den}} \times 100$

In section 7, citizen claims are further broken down into 5 numbers, submitted claims, acknowledged claims, resolved claims, response rate ([Responded ÷ Submitted] × 100), resolution rate ([Resolved ÷ Submitted] × 100)

4.1.5 Household Climate Vulnerability Index (HCVI)

In section 10, there is Household Climate Vulnerability Index (HCVI) adapted from international climate frameworks (IPCC, 2022; Hahn et al., 2009; FAO, 2016):

$$\text{Vulnerability} = \text{Exposure} + \text{Sensitivity} - \text{Adaptive Capacity} \tag{4.1}$$

Household Climate Vulnerability Index (HCVI) Master Composite Formula

$$\textbf{HCVI} = \underbrace{(\text{EI} \times 0.30)}_{\text{30\% Exposure Weight}} + \underbrace{(\text{SI} \times 0.30)}_{\text{30\% Sensitivity Weight}} + \underbrace{[(100 - \text{ACI}) \times 0.40]}_{\text{40\% Adaptive Capacity Deficit Weight}}$$

Composite score from 0 to 100. Lower numbers show resilience; higher numbers show vulnerability.

You calculate the % in 0-100 range for 3 sub-index as following:

EXPOSURE INDEX (EI)

$$EI = \left(\frac{\text{Raw Score}}{20}\right) \times 100$$

5 items × 4 pts max = 20 pts

SENSITIVITY INDEX (SI)

$$SI = \left(\frac{\text{Raw Score}}{20}\right) \times 100$$

5 items × 4 pts max = 20 pts

ADAPTIVE CAPACITY (ACI)

$$ACI = \left(\frac{\text{Raw Score}}{24}\right) \times 100$$

6 items × 4 pts max = 24 pts

Sub-index A. Exposure (Q10.1 to Q10.5, max. 20 points) include i) Frequency of hazard in 3 years ii) Time affected iii) Months affected per year iv) Temporary evacuation v) Daily livelihood disruptions. Value of each item is 0-4. Sub-index B. Sensitivity (Q10.6 to 10.10, max. 20 points) include i) Months of food shortage ii) Period of income loss iii) Damage to properties iv) Problem in drinking water v) Number of vulnerable dependent persons required additional support. Value of each item is 0-4. Sub-index C. Adaptive Capacity (Q10.11 to Q10.16, max. 24 points) include i) Access to early warning ii) Actions for readiness to disasters iii) Adoption at least one CSA practice iv) Initiation of risk reduction oriented IGA v) Membership in community group vi) Preventive health actions. Value of each item is 0-4 (0 or 4 binary for CSA, IGA, and preventive health).

Table 4.4. HCVI Score Interpretation Bands

Score Band	EI Level	SI Level	ACI Level	HCVI Status
0–<20	Very Low Exposure	Very Low Sensitivity	Very Low Capacity	**Very Low Vulnerability**
20–<40	Low Exposure	Low Sensitivity	Low Capacity	**Low Vulnerability**
40–<60	Moderate Exposure	Moderate Sensitivity	Moderate Capacity	**Moderate Vulnerability**
60–<80	High Exposure	High Sensitivity	High Capacity	**High Vulnerability**
80–100	Very High Exposure	Very High Sensitivity	Very High Capacity	**Very High Vulnerability**

I have discussed with Md. Ajazul Haque during our walk through why Adaptive Capacity should be considered as 40% weighted and inverted (100 − ACI). RDRS cannot prevent River Flood, we cannot shift char family's island. We can train farmers, can provide capital, form groups, it directly contributes Adaptive Capacity.

4.1.6 The MEL matrix and the C-RANGPUR digital pipeline

Ref. for the survey planning is spreadsheet F01-112, tab "Monitoring Planning". From Table 4.5 we copy complete row for Planning for Indicator 1.1.

Table 4.5. MEL Matrix Planning Row for Indicator 1.1

Matrix Field	Specification in File F01-112
Indicator Title	Targeted climate-affected households adopting ≥1 additional IGA, +25% from baseline
Quantitative Data Needed	Household ID; baseline/current IGAs; enterprise type; launch date; monthly income earned
Qualitative Data Needed	Motivation for adoption; operational challenges; market barriers; perceived household benefits
Disaggregation	Sex and age of household head; disability status; geographic zone; poverty classification
Data Source	Target rural households in program unions
Collection Method	Structured household survey; Key Informant Interviews
Reporting Schedule	Baseline survey, semi-annual review, and annual consolidation

Figure 4.2 illustrates how data from C-RANGPUR is taken from mobile to Power BI. Table 4.6 is a summary of the five technical questions I asked Md. Ajazul Haque about the C-RANGPUR data flow.

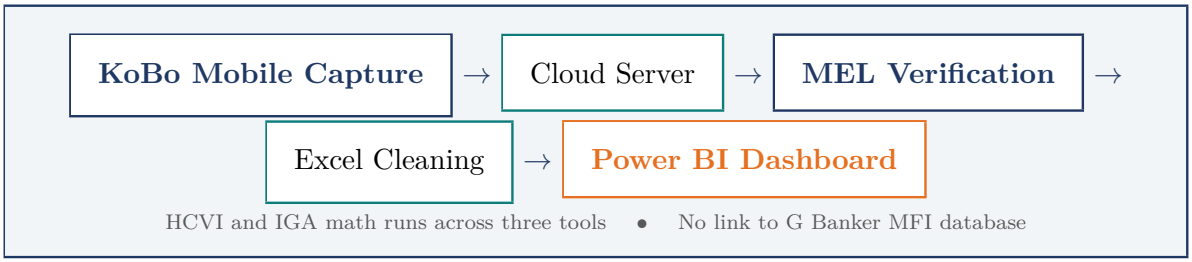


Figure 4.2. The C-RANGPUR data flow from phone capture to Power BI.

4.1.7 Microfinance software evolution: Micro Bank to South Tech to G Banker

Mr. Iftekharul Islam guided me to understand the evolution of MIS in micro finance for 30 years. I particularly remembered this part, because of my family relationship.

Table 4.6. Key Informant Interview with Md. Ajazul Haque, Manager (MEL)

#	Question Asked	Manager's Answer
1	Does KoBo calculate HCVI automatically?	No single tool runs it all; raw data exports to Excel for weighting macros before moving to Power BI.
2	What is the numeric "Code" column for?	Codes let staff load survey tables straight into SPSS for correlation and variance runs.
3	Do submissions hit the dashboard live?	Forms upload to the KoBo server right away, then wait for manual MEL checking before entering Power BI.
4	How are baselines checked against final targets?	The baseline locks the starting value; later rounds compare annual progress against that fixed point.
5	Does project MEL share data with G Banker?	No integration exists between them. Project M&E stays on KoBo/Power BI while microfinance stays in G Banker.

1995-1997 (time when RDRS formally launched microfinance). Back then field people were called ATMs (Assistant Thana Managers). The first package was Micro Bank, which was developed with the help of FAO and GTZ, from Germany (my notebook has "ZTZ" but pretty sure he meant GTZ). 27 developers worked on the package including my grandfather (Boro Abbu) and his colleague Mahabub. My grandfather was mostly managing the various reporting queries in Micro Bank after it was rolled out. We were dependent on him too much as RDRS. Having one person with all the reporting knowledge is dangerous. For an org that big, everything stops if that person gets sick/retires.

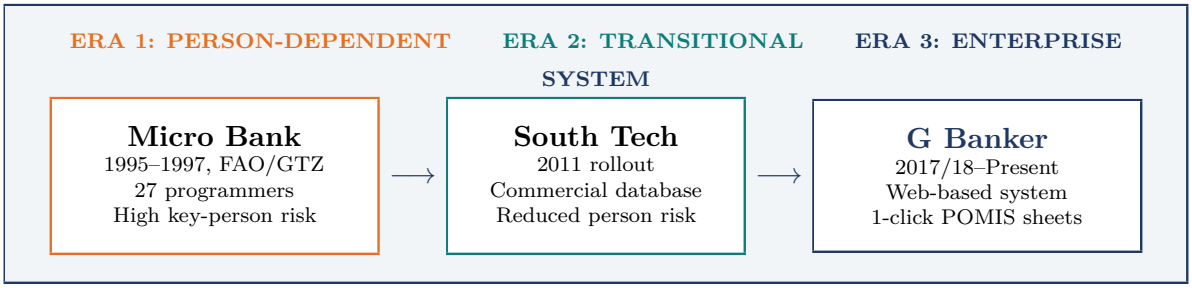


Figure 4.3. Three generations of microfinance MIS software at RDRS: 1995 to 2026.

RDRS hired South Tech in 2011, to eliminate the single-person bottleneck. Data transfer was facilitated by my grandfather, he established the new process and then retired. RDRS

upgraded their microfinance package to G Banker in 2017 or 2018, G Banker is web-based microfinance package developed in BD.

All 288 branches use G Banker today. I saw 3 live outputs from the system. Micro Finance Program Changes Report (sample I checked was Udayan office) where you can see month-to-month changes by Credit Organizer. Number of COs, number of samities, member savings, number of borrowers, overdue loans, outstanding balance, OTR/PAR ratio, profit/loss, disbursement, write-offs etc. Statement of Financial Position from the branch by POMIS-5 is printed for this year vs previous year. Monthly/yearly Statement of Comprehensive Income and Expenditure is printed directly from daily inputs of the branches by POMIS-4.

4.2 Data Flow: From Grassroots Field Units to Management Dashboards

The monthly monitoring schedule guides the movement of field data to management along two distinct channels (Figure 4.4).



Figure 4.4. Dual-track monitoring flow coordinated by the MEL Department.

Figure 4.4 demonstrates how the two distinct channels translate into field staff responsibilities. For microfinance, monthly monitoring 02-15 and 16-28 September 2026 for two sets of ten repeat audits of branch performance are assigned to named monitoring officers. They audit group loans and savings, evaluate staff productivity, monitor cash collection and refunds, audit loan disbursement documents, supervise loan ceilings and delinquent accounts, audit write-off and rescheduling, perform 100% audit reconciliation, examine write-off, adjust for misappropriation, and review pre-service training.

September development responsibilities were defined by donor grants. These included: Baseline for C-RANGPUR (six districts), DHIS2 validation of data in MCGL (Panchagarh), DQA and ELCO and Pregnant Women checks for Jononni (Lalmonirhat and Rangpur), SEEDS Education checks in Rangpur, Live ICPS baseline (Saiful Alam Sekul and Fahmida Mostafa) in Mymensingh, Rajshahi, and Rangpur divisions, RERP Post-Distribution in Cox's Bazar, and CALDRI beneficiary checks in Kurigram.

4.3 Field Visit to Lalmonirhat: Watching the Jononni Project

Just reading the schedule in Rangpur will be a limited approach. So, I went out to Lalmonirhat for Jononni field visit for development monitoring. The 'Jononni' (strengthening maternal and neonatal health system in Rangpur project with Save the Children from March 2023 to Dec 2027 officially), was listed on the schedule for monitoring in September (DQA and beneficiaries' verification).

Went to see the head of the Jononni project at RDRS before leaving. Forgot to put his full name down in my field notebook that day, but he gave me a rundown of how the project follows maternal health data across clinics and village clusters. I observed field people in Lalmonirhat checking off Eligible Couple (ELCO) lists and Pregnant Women (PW) registers against monthly clinic summaries and Data Quality Assessment (DQA) sheets. For maternal health, unlike microfinance where G Banker 'forces' column totals to be even every night, a lot of the monitoring depends on keeping the handwritten follow-up cards for pregnancy and safe delivery and postnatal visits nice and orderly by community workers. If the outreach worker misses an update for a household move, or puts a date down on ELCO card that doesn't quite match up, the monthly count can start to slip further away from reality until some monitoring officer comes to check the registers in the union by hand.

At this Lalmonirhat, one incident was quite surprising. There I met with my one university teacher at Begum Rokeya University (BRUR). The name is Mr. Omar Faruque. The position is the Assoc. Professor, Department of Accounting, BRUR. He was also involved in Jononni's project activities in that place. I never thought that I will meet with a university teacher in this kind of project field. We had a long conversation about the

actual behavior of NGO project documentation / expense voucher / monitoring checks at the rural union as against accounting and MIS classes. I was assured by the fact that university teacher is looking at these field register books. That means, verification culture is practiced across financial accounting and project MIS.

4.4 Special Monitoring Protocols: Where MIS Meets Physical Verification

Yes, software warns of anomaly. But people must go and investigate villages to look at papers. There is a special monitoring fixed checklist for MEL Dept. when they go for branch visit. The checklist is copied from departmental internal papers.

If G Banker raises alert for loan overdue, the monitoring officer will visit borrower's residence, record exact note for nonpayment and hand over the note to the branch loan committee. Before new loans get regularized, the officers are cross-checking the sanction sheets by the loan committees. This is done by cross checking with cash disbursement slips and borrower's pass book. This way we can find out phantom loans. We are also keeping track with high risk loans which is over the threshold. The tracking will be on a monthly basis against Portfolio At Risk (PAR) and Overdue To Total Receivables (OTR). We will create a separate tracking file if we find any suspects of cash skimming / forgery. It will be based on branch complaint boxes. Area Manager, Regional manager and District manager also make unannounced visit at higher level than branch.

4.5 Risk Control Linked to MIS: Credit Shield Microinsurance

We have been doing Credit Shield Insurance through Guardian Life Insurance Limited since July 2024 with RDRS. In this, borrower needs to pay a compulsory premium of BDT 6 per BDT 1,000 disbursement. In case of death of borrower or co-borrower this Insurance will wipe out the rest loan amount(principal + service charge accrued up to BDT 20 lakh) and it will also provide immediate BDT 15,000 funeral cash grant to the family.

Though at the end G Banker will do the write off of the loan, the claim process is slow paper based.

Death Confirmed at Branch ⟶ Branch Focal Verifies (2 days) ⟶ Regional Focal Review ⟶ Central Focal (Dhaka) ⟶ Guardian Life (10 days) ⟶ Payout (5 days)

The physical folders of death certificates and medical notes and union parishad attestation are travelling from the remote branch to Dhaka. Paper is making everything slow. Scanning the claim files directly to G Banker would save many days for settlement.

4.6 Regulatory Recordkeeping: AML/CFT

Anti-Money Laundering and Combating the Financing of Terrorism Policy (since Jan-2022). As per this policy we keep in an internal register for trustees, higher management and huge financial transactions [7]. Here we keep National ID, Tax Identifier (TIN), permanent address, photo and outside board roles. This information we use to make filing for Bangladesh Bank and BFIU, Bangladesh Financial Intelligence Unit. Cash transaction is filed for BFIU if the amount exceeds BDT 50,00,000. Threshold filing is made for BFIU.

4.7 Credit Governance and Approval Authority

Loan approvals move up a clear chain based on loan size:

Credit Organizer (Recommends) ⟶ Branch Manager (≤BDT 1.5L) ⟶ Area Manager (≤BDT 3.0L) ⟶ Regional Manager (≤BDT 5.0L) ⟶ Head of Microfinance (>BDT 5.0L)

When our Monitoring officers do branch audit, they go up the same ladder in reverse to see that if actually huge loans are made with signature of Area or Regional (before loan disbursement).

4.8 Case Study: Access to Justice for Women (A2J)

I went to Access to Justice for Women (A2J) team, Rangpur to learn monitoring beyond credit and survey [13]. This is a bilateral (G2G) project by Law and Justice Division

(MoLJPA) and Germany through GIZ. Project duration 1 March 2024 to 31 December 2026. With extension up to March 2027. Budget in Rangpur is BDT 1,82,25,931. I went to the room where I found a Project Focal (who has been in RDRS for over 28 years) District Project Officer, two paralegals. If I calculate people (as per list of team member role they mentioned), we have 12 people (6 paralegals, 1 DPO, 1 Finance/Admin officer, 3 support staff and 1 project focal). But in a handwritten note on their slide, we have 13 (I mentioned this to confirm from HR).

Formally and informally justice system separated among two partner NGOs. RDRS on formal court, DLAO, Police station and Rangpur central prison. And, Nijera Kori at Community Dispute Resolution (CDR) at village level. RDRS has provided justice services to 6,092 (3,348 female and 2,744 male) justice seeker up to April 2025. Also, maintained a Legal Service Information Desk (LSID) in court premises. Coordinated DLAC, UZLAC and UPLAC committees. Achieved Office Order from Senior District and Sessions Judge (18 March 2025) to use the trained mediators for *aposh-joggo* cases (compoundable cases) under the Code of Criminal Procedure (CrPC) in Rangpur district.

For district courts lack of digital query API to NGOs, then 06 nos RDRS paralegal has conducted physical case load counting. By physically visit at every bench of Rangpur in April 2025. For example physically visited court room Ejlash benches. And, clerk's Serestha rooms for case load counting. Total 77,849 number of pending cases found. Among them criminal cases 44,215 (56.8%) and civil cases are 33,634 (43.2%) (Figure 4.5 and Table 4.7).

For example, in the Nari O Shishu Tribunal-1 there were 3662 cases for criminal and only 9 cases in Anti Terrorism tribunal. For civil cases it was Land Survey tribunal 5,493 cases whereas Additional District and Sessions Judge-1 only 51. It is a bad paper registry, when 06 number of paralegal has physical count tens of thousands of paper folders. And, also, provide services to clients in prison, LSID desk in the court premises.

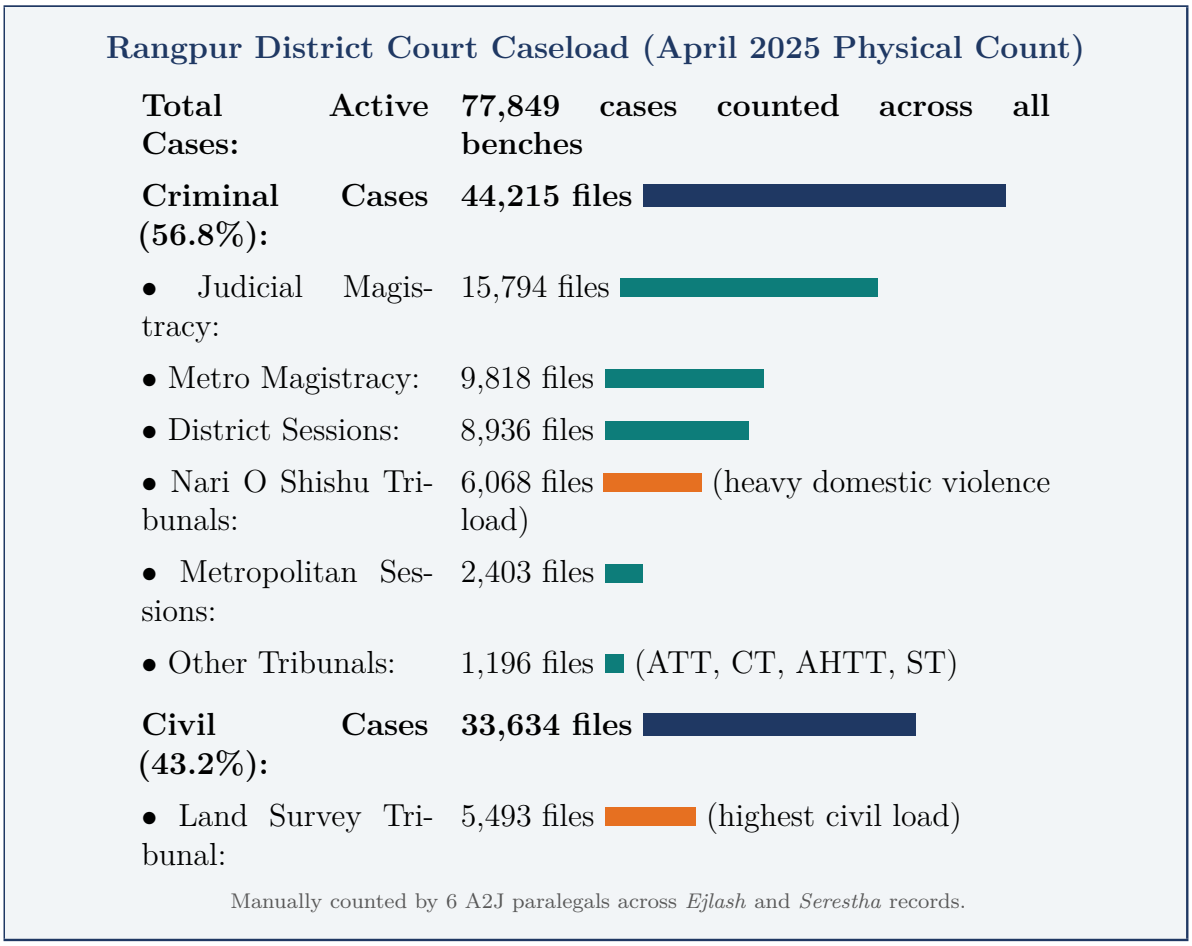


Figure 4.5. Rangpur District court caseload from the April 2025 manual audit.

Table 4.7. Criminal Caseload Breakdown in Rangpur Courts (April 2025)

Sl	Jurisdiction	Court / Tribunal Category	Sub-total	Total Files
1	Magistracy	Judicial Magistracy (including GRO dockets)	15,794	25,612
		Metropolitan Magistracy (including GRO dockets)	9,818	
2	Sessions Courts	District Sessions Bench	8,936	11,339
		Metropolitan Sessions Bench	2,403	
3	Tribunals	Nari O Shishu Nirjatan Daman Tribunals	6,068	7,264
		Specialized Tribunals (ATT, CT, AHTT, ST)	1,196	
Total Criminal Cases Counted				**44,215**

4.9 Building Dishari: Fixing the Manual Schedule and Reporting Problem

I saw an irony sitting within MEL Department in October and November right on the desk of the coordinator. The monitoring officers are going in field every month to detect the reporting errors of the branches. But the monthly calendar which is deploying the monitoring officers to the field is manually done within Microsoft Word tables. The yearly branch coverage report is calculated manually.

4.9.1 Problems in the manual Word schedule and reporting flow

The coordinator every month used to open the previous month's word file and change on a landscape table of six columns. The table had 9 permanent monitoring officers (Moyen Uddin, Md. Nuruzzaman, Kartick Bhowmik, Jamir Uddin, Sanchya Sarker, Mamunur Rashid, Rashedul Islam, Anwarul Islam, Md. Laku Mia) and few temporary managers (e.g., Maydul Islam, Iftekharul Islam, etc.). We had to face the following five headaches each and every cycle.

1. In Bangladesh, since the weekly off days are Friday/Saturday, and there are also government/moon-sighting holidays, it took some manual work to figure out the days you can work. A day off counting error caused a weekend visit.
2. By having branch names typed off the top of our heads in more than 300 offices, we ended up introducing slight spelling differences which caused a later search in spreadsheets to fail.
3. Word tables don't notify you if by mistake two officers are booked into the same branch during the same visit window or if an officer is being sent back to a branch they were just at last month.
4. Manually have to painstakingly join all the 8 numbered monitoring activities (vertical in all the officer rows). Align column widths and fix page breaks to make it printable on A4 landscape.
5. After the month was complete, the Word document was all alone in a folder. It wasn't easy to see at a glance how many branches we visited of the ones that we were

cataloging, which of the northern districts were lagging, or how many field days the officers were having.

4.9.2 How I designed and built Dishari

To solve these problems for MEL team I developed a web application (**Dishari**, pathfinder/navigator) on the client side using React 19.2, TypeScript 6.0, Vite 8.3 and Tailwind CSS 4.3. Yes, fully browser based (deliberate). NGO dept should not have to pay monthly cloud server bills, should not have to remember DB logins. Planning should not stop because of Rangpur internet failure. All data is stored in browser's localStorage under msp:* keys (e.g., msp:settings, msp:holidays, msp:month:YYYY-MM, msp:meta at Schema Version 3) with protective adapter (src/lib/storage-adapter.ts). It falls back to in-memory if browser-storage is full. JSON full backup is exported for easy transfer between laptops.

We broke monthly scheduling into 3 distinct phases (1 Plan, 2 Assign, 3 Review) with a specific Reports view to support them.

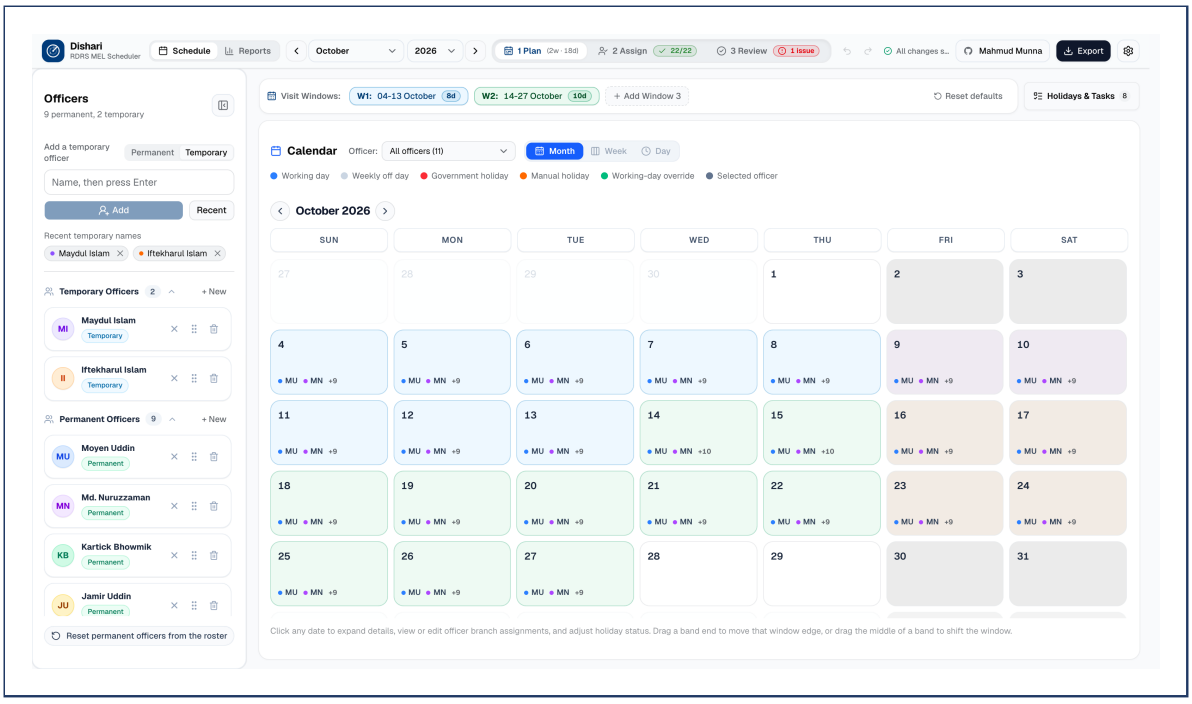


Figure 4.6. Dishari Step 1 (Plan): Sunday-first October 2026 calendar, draggable visit windows, and officer roster.

Step 1 (Plan) (Figure **??**): the coordinator will have 2-3 visit windows in a Sunday first calendar, with Friday and Saturday in the right gray columns. When window edge dragged over a holiday or weekend, it neatly snaps to the closest work day using pure calendar math (src/lib/working-days.ts, src/lib/schedule-ops.ts). The pill for each window shows a live count of work days (e.g., 04-13 Oct 8d, 14-27 Oct 10d). Clicking a date brings up a Day Overview popup with all officers active on that day. This could have custom ranges like Md. Nuruzzaman's extra-long 04-15 Oct window for the first window. I found early on that with regular JS Date.toISOString() and UTC conversions, dates would get skewed back 6 hours in Bangladesh's UTC+6 time zone. This could cause an officer to end up on the wrong day. I moved all date operations in src/lib/date.ts to pure YYYY-MM-DD local strings with strict overflow checks. No dates are ever converted to UTC. Side drawer holds 8 numbered monitoring tasks. Bangladesh Gazette or moon sighting holidays can be imported in English and Bengali with tolerant JSON parser (src/lib/holidays.ts).

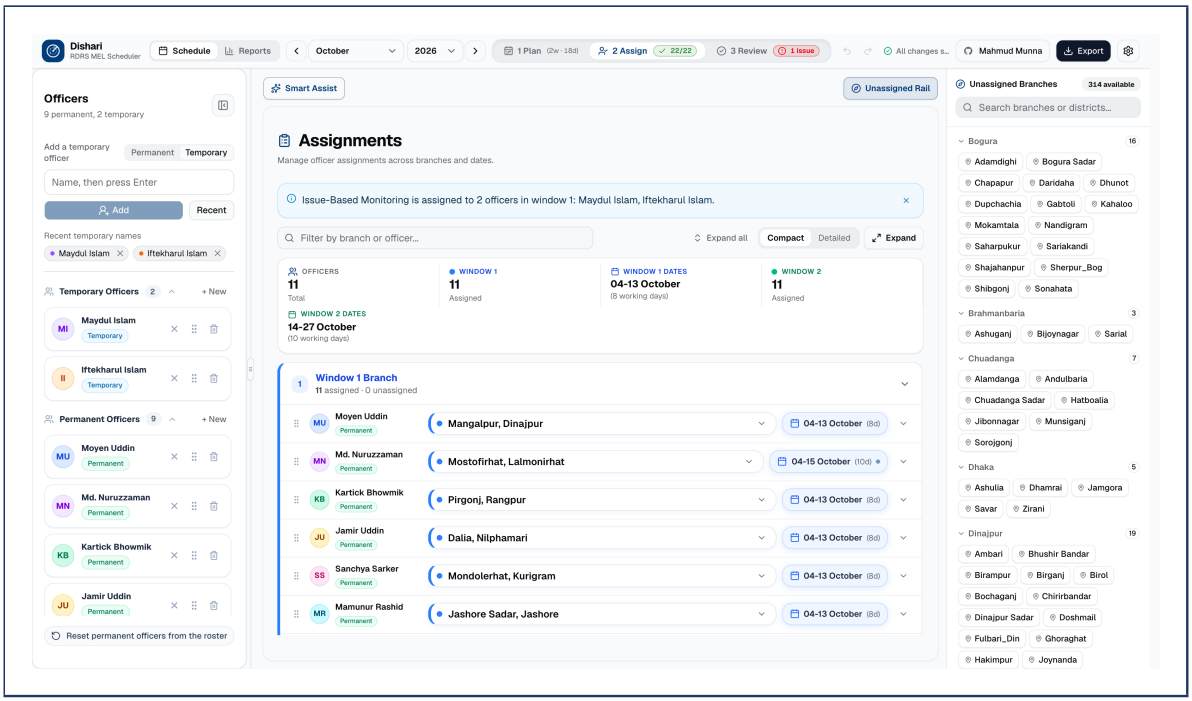


Figure 4.7. Dishari Step 2 (Assign): 22 officer-window slots, searchable 332-branch catalog, and Unassigned Branches rail.

In Step 2, Assign (see Figure **??**) the officer's row is bound to a searchable branch combobox (src/components/branch-combobox.tsx) with 332 initial master branches from 32 district strings (src/lib/branch-master-data.ts, note normalization for spellings src/lib/branches.ts

handles, eg Narsingdi, Narshingdi), with instant shortcut branching presets for "Issue-Based Monitoring", and "Special Visit at". An expandable right side column shows the remaining branches to choose from by district, each can be added by clicking it. Branches can be moved between rows by dragging-dropping a handle. I implemented Smart Assist, rule-based suggestAssignments, rotateFromLastMonth (src/lib/suggest.ts) to populate gaps for months quickly: prevent already chosen branches for the month; implement strict 3-month officer lockout: no one gets re-assigned to any branch in three months; provide 100 base points for not having been visited. +25 point bonus if no visits to any district within a timeframe.

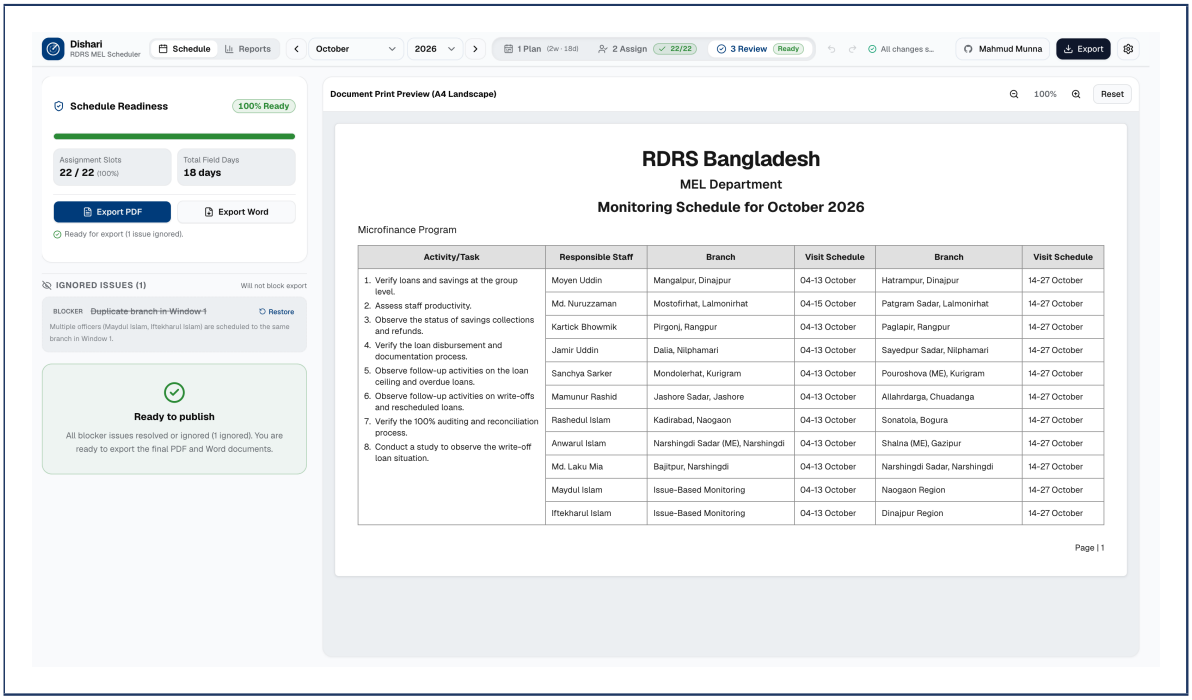


Figure 4.8. Dishari Step 3 (Review): 0 to 100 readiness checker, ignored exception tray, and live A4 Landscape Print Preview.

In Step 3 (Review) (Figure **??**), there's a diagnostic engine (assessScheduleReadiness in src/lib/readiness.ts) that evaluates the draft against 0-100 (60 for slot completion, 30 for zero blockers (duplicate branches, unassigned officers), 10 for zero warnings (window length less than 4 working days, overlapping windows, 3 month repeats of officers). Fix will take you directly to edit the row it's concerned about. If you purposefully set up two temp managers to "Issue-Based Monitoring" Window 1 (e.g. see RDRS's September sheet) Ignore will push that check to an audited IGNORED ISSUES tray (with Restore button)

and get you up to 100% Ready. Rather than duplicating layout code for screen preview, and pdf and word exports, we create a single canonical table matrix with vertical rowSpan merges for the document model (buildDocumentModel, src/lib/document-model.ts). The screen preview, the vector pdf exporter (jsPDF, jspdf-autotable in src/lib/export-pdf.ts) and editable .docx generator (docx in src/lib/export-docx.ts) all use the same document model. So screen and print won't diverge.

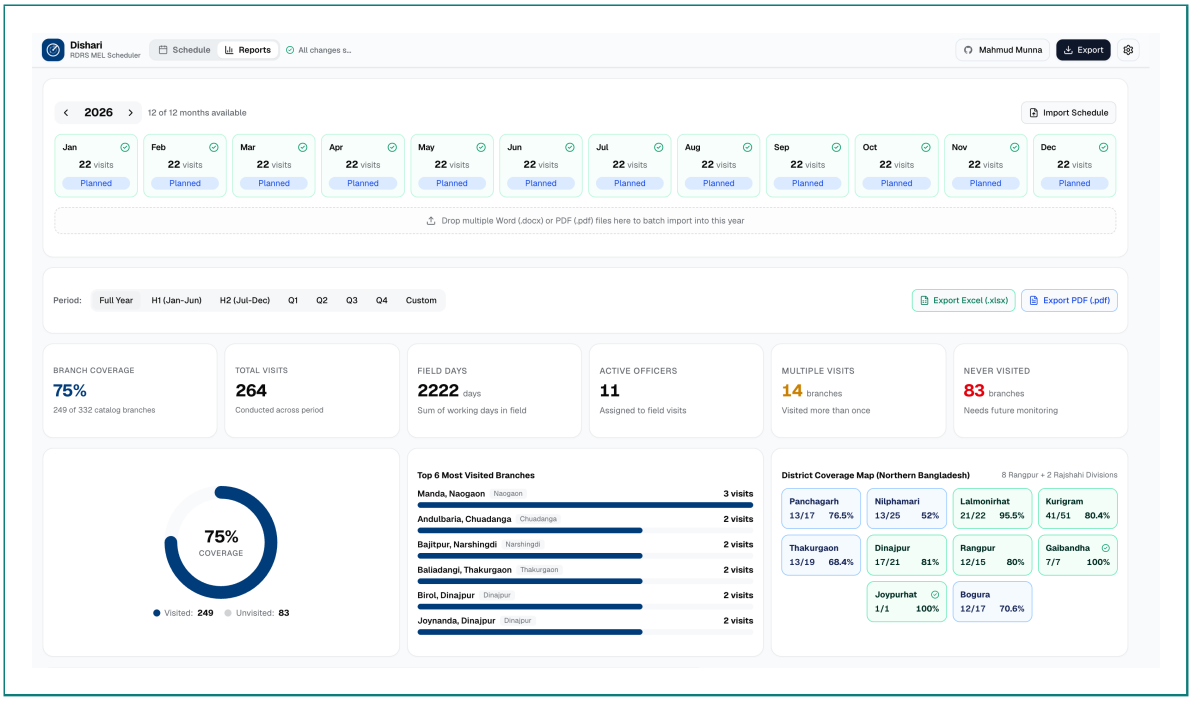


Figure 4.9. Dishari Reports view (shown on the illustrative 12-month 2026 demo dataset): KPI cards, SVG coverage donut, top branches, and Northern Bangladesh district tile map.

The Reports tab (Figure **??**) clears the multi-month reporting visibility gap. I added client-side parsers (src/lib/import-docx.ts with JSZip parsing Word XML and src/lib/import-pdf.ts with pdfjs-dist coordinate clustering) to reuse existing schedules. The coordinator can simply drag and drop existing .docx or .pdf files into Year Coverage panel to get the contents without retyping. buildReport (src/lib/report.ts) will calculate branch coverage, officer working days by field, unvisited branches, district percentages, month coverage matrix over the selected range (Full Year / half-year / quarter / custom months), and a Data Quality tab with detection of misspelled branch names. I produce 5 pure-SVG charts for numbers (src/components/reports/report-charts.tsx) with no 3rd party charting libraries. Clicking the buttons will export a 7-sheet .xlsx workbook for Excel (exceljs) or

executive PDF. Figure **??** shows 75% coverage (249 of 332 branches over 264 visits) which is the demo data for 12-month Dishari's illustrative dataset for checking full-year reporting before closing all actuals in 2026.

Table 4.8. Manual Word Schedule Workflow Compared to Dishari

Task	Old Manual Word Process	With Dishari
Day & holiday math	Counted by hand around Fri/Sat and holidays	Auto-snapping windows + English/Bengali holiday JSON import
Branch picking	Typed from memory; spelling drift	Searchable 332-branch catalog + Smart Assist (3-mo cooldown)
Error checks	Visual proofreading only	0–100 readiness engine blocking same-window duplicates
Print & export	Manual Word `rowSpan` cell merging	Single `buildDocumentModel` generating A4 PDF and Word `.docx`
Annual tracking	12 isolated files; manual counting	Batch `.docx`/`.pdf` import, SVG charts, 7-sheet Excel export

I used automated tests (Vitest 5.0.3 and React Testing Library) for Dishari's schedule math, timezone safety, parser leniency, readiness conditions, UI sequence, etc. so that at the end, I had 294 unit tests passing, 31 test files, 100% success rate. No TypeScript or Oxlint error. Also, Coordinators can easily undo accidental edits because we have an undo-redo history stack of 50 steps each month (src/state/history.ts).

4.10 Observed Strengths of Current MIS Practices

We have some existing practices in RDRS that are good in real world. Eg., G Banker can print out branch balance sheet, income statement and Credit Organizer sheets for all 288 offices at a single click of the mouse. It saves days of clerical jobs each month. Our MEL Department has transparent monthly schedule where we know exactly which officers, branches, what date, etc. Instead of adhoc-report-hunting. The routine jobs split to regular Excel sheets and the variable baseline surveys to KoBo Toolbox. Very good for field work.

4.11 Observed Gaps and Field-Level Data Discrepancies

We have major challenges in the transition from paper to numbers, i.e. digital. For example, when we looked at the May 2023 monitoring report of the PKSF funded Somriddhi Programme in Panchagarh and Kurigram, there were obvious gaps (Figure 4.10).

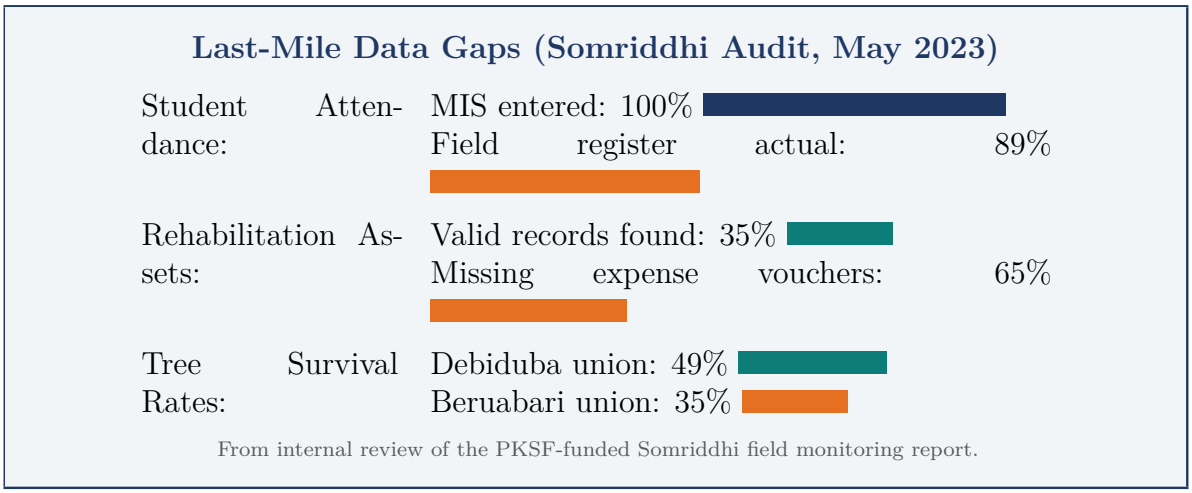


Figure 4.10. Field register versus central MIS gaps recorded in the Somriddhi audit.

For non formal education centers, the central MIS tables show 100% attendance. Whereas the physical classroom roll books show 89%. For 74 learning centers, 11 centers have changed teachers in 4 months which breaks the continuity of reporting. And for ultra poor households where rehabilitation assets of about 100,000 BDT were given. During field check, 65% of expenditure vouchers cannot be traced. Survival rate of fruit tree is 35% in Beruabari (vs 49% in Debiduba). And it is important for the MIS data. Because, this is same reconciliation of attendance data like the passbook of borrower vs G Banker but it is programme level reconciliation.

C-RANGPUR has some minor codebook issues. Title of the project is Q5.3.2: C RANGPU and Q5.4.1: C RANGPUR, typed. Also, there's a title "Indicator 3.2 Measurement Matrix" before Section 8 but Section 8 is measuring Indicator 3.1. Plus, many of the multi-selects also get collapsed into 1 option string exports (Word). So Power BI scripts need to parse the 0/1 binary nice and clean for KoBo.

4.12 Summary Findings Matrix

Table 4.9 gives a list of all the strengths/weaknesses/available tools.

4.13 Placement Activity Log

Table 4.10 summarizes my visits, sittings, file reviews, software changes over 3 months as per the official schedule at end of this report.

Table 4.10: Internship Fieldwork and Office Activity Log

Date	Activity	Who I worked with	Notes and takeaways
01 Sep 2026	Induction and reporting rules	Mr. Mamunur Rashid; Dabasish Mahata	Got my placement plan and read the 6th Strategic Plan; wrote down 406 Federations and 1.64M reach.
02–04 Sep 2026	Overview of MEL tools and projects	Mr. Iftekharul Islam; Fahmida Mostafa	Learned how routine Excel sheets, KoBo mobile forms, and Power BI fit together across five areas.
07–09 Sep 2026	Microfinance MIS history talk	Mr. Iftekharul Islam	Traced Micro Bank (1995–97, Boro Abbu's 27-dev team) to South Tech (2011) and G Banker (2017/18).
10–11 Sep 2026	Checking live G Banker reports	Udayan Branch Office exports	Read CO-wise Changes Report, POMIS-4, and POMIS-5; saw how one-click OTR and PAR work.
13–17 Sep 2026	C-RANGPUR baseline fieldwork	Moushumi Akter (MDO, 01745761900)	Watched household enumeration on Enketo forms and checked consent screens in the field.

Date	Activity	Who I worked with	Notes and takeaways
20–24 Sep 2026	Branch visits and ledger checks	Maydul Islam (01730328212); Md. Ziaur Rahman (01730328234)	Matched borrower passbooks against branch loan books and checked overdue collection notes.
27 Sep 2026	HR policy rotation	Md. Ziaur Rahman (01730328011)	Saw HR staff records, biometric attendance logs, and how leave tracking runs.
28 Sep 2026	Agriculture and Rupantar briefing	Dr. Salah Uddin (01716263216); Pallab Goswami (01738 375951)	Looked at Climate Smart Agriculture plots, homestead gardening, and flood-tolerant crop data.
29 Sep 2026	Social Development briefing	Rashedul Arefeen (01730328044)	Learned how 406 Union Federations track civic claims and local mediation logs.
30 Sep 2026	Safeguarding policy walkthrough	Rumana Azim Ansari (01730328039)	Reviewed safeguarding complaint registers and confidential incident escalation paths.
01 Oct 2026	Admin and General Service visit	Maj Shammita Kabir (Retd)	Checked procurement registers, store inventory sheets, vehicle logs, and asset tags.
04–16 Oct 2026	Deep MIS practice and Dishari start	Dabasish Mahata; Md. Ajazul Haque	Discussed HCVI 30/30/40 weights and F01-112 formulas; started coding Dishari calendar math.

Date	Activity	Who I worked with	Notes and takeaways
18–22 Oct 2026	Jononni field trip to Lalmonirhat	Jononni Project Head; Assoc. Prof. Omar Faruque (BRUR)	Met the Jononni head, watched ELCO/PW and DQA checks in Lalmonirhat, and spoke with Omar Faruque sir on site.
24–28 Oct 2026	A2J project and court audit review	Project Focal; DPO; Paralegals	Studied formal/informal justice split and the April 2025 manual count of 77,849 court cases.
29 Oct – 05 Nov 2026	Somriddhi file review	MEL Department Archives	Found the 89% vs. 100% attendance gap, 11/74 teacher exits, and 65% missing grant vouchers.
06–12 Nov 2026	Dishari completion and compliance check	Microfinance staff; MEL team	Checked Credit Shield and AML/CFT rules; finished Dishari 3-step workflow, Reports view, and 294 unit tests.
15–25 Nov 2026	Report drafting and review	Mr. Mamunur Rashid	Put together chapters, tables, and recommendations for internal MEL feedback.
26 Nov 2026	Internship presentation	MEL Leadership & Staff	Presented MIS findings and walked staff through Dishari at Rangpur CCO.
30 Nov 2026	Final report submission	Academic Supervisor & Head of MEL	Handed in bound report to BRUR MIS department and RDRS MEL office.

Table 4.9. Consolidated MIS Findings at RDRS Bangladesh

System / Practice	What happens on the ground	Status
G Banker Platform	Instant CO-wise Changes, POMIS-4, and POMIS-5 statements	[STRENGTH] Fast, consistent PAR and OTR reporting
Monthly Schedule	Named officers, branches, and visit windows twice a month	[STRENGTH] Clear staff accountability
KoBo Mobile Surveys	Offline Android/Enketo forms with GPS and quick Excel export	[STRENGTH] Cuts out paper questionnaire retyping
Register-to-MIS Match	89% classroom register attendance entered as 100% in MIS	[GAP] Last-mile inflation; no sign-off gate
Asset Grant Files	65% of rehabilitation vouchers missing in Somriddhi check	[GAP] Weak paper filing at union level
C-RANGPUR Pipeline	HCVI formula split across KoBo, Excel macros, and Power BI	[GAP] Manual handoffs and small typos
Credit Shield Claims	Paper death dossiers routed across 4 office tiers to Dhaka	[GAP] Slow manual transport lags payout
A2J Docket Audit	6 paralegals counted 77,849 paper files across court rooms	[GAP] Heavy manual count burden
Jononni Field Check	ELCO/PW paper card updates checked manually during DQA visits	[GAP] Needs regular on-site reconciliation
Dishari Scheduler App	Built offline React/TS planner for 332 branches and coverage	[STRENGTH] Replaces Word tables; 294 unit tests pass
Microfinance Continuity	Moved from Micro Bank (1995) to South Tech to G Banker	[STRENGTH] Removed key-person reporting risk

CHAPTER 5

Recommendations

Following 3 changes are what I have directly incorporated due to problems/slowdowns encountered in my placement.

5.1 Require a Physical Register Sign-Off Before Monthly Lock

Biggest problem is discrepancy of paper data (say 89% classroom attendance, but Somriddhi MIS shows 100%) with center tables. Or 65% of grant receipts are not available in files. My suggestion is that Monitoring officer should check at least 10% of basic paper data (passbooks/school roll books/ELCO or PW cards/payment receipts) line by line with digital data, before branch manager/project officer closes a monthly G Banker or Excel. Both of them must sign a one-page document before upload. If discrepancies are more than 5% then monthly file should not be locked until resolution.

5.2 Automate the KoBo-to-Power BI Link for Development Projects

Right now, we export C-RANGPUR data from KoBo to Excel. This is where it lives. Someone will run macros for HCVI in Excel. Then we will import this into Power BI. In all this manual copying, you risk errors with formulas and version control. Instead, RDRS should integrate KoBo Toolbox directly to Power BI (or centralized mini-PostgreSQL database) with API webhooks. Then do the $\text{HCVI} = 0.30\,\text{EI} + 0.30\,\text{SI} + 0.40\,(100 - \text{ACI})$ calculations once in Power Query or DAX. Then do a basic validation check to catch typos like "C RANGPU" at the time of submission.

5.3 Adopt Rule-Checked Scheduling with Dishari and Digitize Paper Dossiers

Our current manual monthly schedule making in Word is costing staff time and is blind to annual branch blind spots. MEL Department can make Dishari a regular practice for microfinance monitoring schedule to automatically calculate working days, 3 month cooldown per officer for 332 branches, double check duplicates, and annual district coverage charts without server costs. In addition to scheduling, RDRS should also maintain double-trained owners for all recurring report families to eliminate key-man risks again. Plus scanning and uploading PDFs for death certificate to directly to G Banker. No more waiting for weeks for death certificates to be Dhaka mail pouches for Credit Shield claims.

If resources allow only one change first First of all, do your physical register signoff. In that way you ensure that if there are any bad entries they're not written to the central tables. That saves everything down the line, in terms of dashboards etc.

CHAPTER 6

Conclusion

I assumed that an internship with BBA MIS in RDRS Bangladesh was all about SQL queries and servers and software windows. However, after spending three months in Rangpur and field towns (e.g. Lalmonirhat) my thinking has changed a bit. Software is only useful for good data (in field/districts) if good data checking habits have been established.

RDRS Microfinance is pretty much sorted out on the hard bit. Switching from Micro Bank (1990s) to South Tech and then G Banker for 288 branches gave managers quick access to balance sheets and PAR ratios. There's no need to fear that the formulas for the ledger are lost forever if one programmer retires. The problems we still have are pretty much where paper meets software. - Where samity passbooks and maternal health cards line up with monthly tables. - Reducing manual excel steps from KoBo surveys. - Scanning paper files from Credit Shield. - Moving officer monthly roster off of Word tables into software like Dishari. And seeing actual work in ICPS and C-RANGPUR and Jononni and A2J (as well as older audit reports) showed me both sides of the equation.

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Legal Assistance, Court Audits, and Case Management Deck, Rangpur, April 2025.

APPENDIX A

Appendices

A.1 Semi-Structured Field Interview Guide

For my interviews with MEL officers and project coordinators and branch people, I had 5 basic questions (no fixed script): - Which paper forms/excel spreadsheets/phone apps are they using to gather primary numbers. - Who checks raw sheets before they go further up, and what is signed. - Which offices the data flows through, from branch to Rangpur to Dhaka. - Which software does the calculation itself vs. what needs to be manually calculated in excel. - Which paper records / software totals have the most discrepancies.

A.2 Glossary of Local and Court Terms

The standard general monitoring abbreviations are in the first abbreviations box. The following are a few Bengali, field, and court specific words that were used a lot in interviews: *Aposh-joggo* - (compounded offenses per Bangladesh Code of Criminal Procedure (CrPC) which are legally able to be compromised/settled by parties or in court annexed mediation). *Ejlash* - open courtroom and elevated bench where judge/magistrate hold court. *Serestha* - court clerk's office with physical case files, cause list, and dockets. *Federation* - (an independent community group formed by RDRS at the union level to lobby for local rights and government allowances). *Monga* - (traditional lean season in northwestern Bangladesh between planting and harvest (usually Sep-Nov) where farm work slows down). *Samity* - (village microcredit group (15-30 women) meeting weekly for savings and loan repayments).

A.3 C-RANGPUR Verification Notes

I noticed three items to check when reviewing the C-RANGPUR word questionnaire and the matrix `F01-112` with Md. Ajazul Haque. One, be sure project documents will show the exact number of Upazila and Unions in each of the 6 target districts (Rangpur, Lalmonirhat, Kurigram, Sirajganj, Gaibandha, and Jamalpur). Two, matrix file `F01-112` shows 'semi-annual' and 'annual' beside Indicator 1.1. Staff need to confirm if semi-annual is being used in internal dashboards and annual is used for donors, etc. Three, staff could avoid copy/paste issues if they could move HCVI scoring to Power BI queries and not do it manually in Excel workbooks.

A.4 Access to Justice (A2J) Field Notes

In the A2J presentation deck and court walkthrough, 2 items on my pad that needed to be confirmed. (1) the team indicated 12 active posts (6 paralegals; 1 District Project Officer; 1 Finance/Admin Officer; 3 support staff; 1 Project Focal). The handwritten figure on the slide indicates 13. Should verify against HR sheet. (2) it should be monitored how many cases move out of formal court queue. Staff should be tracking referrals made to panel of mediators (as approved by Senior District and Sessions Judge on 18 March 2025)

Schedule for the Internship Program at RDRS Bangladesh

Schedule for the Internship Program at RDRS Bangladesh

Participant: Student of BBA, Begum Rokeya University, Rangpur

Duration: 01 September 2026 to 30 November 2026

Purpose: The purpose of this internship program is to provide practical exposure to MIS practices in project monitoring for RDRS Bangladesh. The program aims to bridge the gap between theoretical knowledge and real-world practice.

Date	Location	Main Activities	Responsible/Contact Person	Remarks
01 September 2026	Central Coordination Office, Rangpur	Orientation and Reporting Guidelines	Mr. Mamunur Rashid, Head of MEL Dabasish Mahata, Coordinator-Monitoring	
02-10 September 2026	Central Coordination Office, Rangpur	Overview of RDRS Bangladesh Programs and Projects	Mr. Iftekharul Islam, Manager-Monitoring Fahmida Mostafa, Senior MEL Officer	
13-17 September 2026	C-RANGPU Project	Baseline Data Collection of C-RANGPU Project	Moushumi Akter, MDO, CRANGPU Project 01745761900	

Date	Location	Main Activities	Responsible/Contact Person	Remarks
20-24 September 2026	Rangpur Region	Branch Office Visit, Observe Data Verification, and Documentation Process	Maydul Islam Senior Monitoring Officer 01730328212 Md. Ziaur Rahman Senior Officer, Admin & MIS 01730328234	
27 September 2026	HR Department Rangpur	Know about HRM Policy and Process	Md. Ziaur Rahman, Sr. Coordinator-HR 01730328011	
28 September 2026	Rupantar Project, Rangpur	Activities of Agriculture Department and Rupantar Project	Dr. Salah Uddin, Team Leader Environment & Climate Change 01716263216 Pallab Goswami, Research Associate, 01738 375951	
29 September 2026	Social Development, Rangpur	Briefing on Social Empowerment Activities and the Federation Concept	Rashedul Arefeen Team Leader (SD) 01730328044	
30 September 2026	Safeguarding Department, Rangpur	RDRS Safeguarding Policy and Practice	Rumana Azim Ansari, Coordinator-Safeguarding 01730328039	

Date	Location	Main Activities	Responsible/Contact Person	Remarks
1 October 2026	Admin and General Service Department, Rangpur	RDRS Administrative and General Service activities (Procurement, GH, Store & GS)	Maj Shammita Kabir (Retd), Head of Admin & General Service	
4 October - 12 November 2026	Rangpur Central Coordination Office	MIS practice in MEL Department	Dabasish Mahata, Ajazul Haque, MEL Department	
15-25 November 2026	Rangpur Central Coordination Office	Report preparation and sharing of learning with RDRS Bangladesh	Mamunur Rashid, Head of MEL	
26 November 2026	Rangpur Central Coordination Office	Internship Presentation Session	Mamunur Rashid Head of MEL	
30 November 2026	Rangpur Central Coordination Office	Final Report Submission	Mamunur Rashid Head of MEL	